FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-33-17002

Issue Title : Intermittent or Inoperative Forward Position Lights

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3343-00	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
12/01/2017	05/17/2018	05/16/2018
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Added Service Letter release information.

Applicability

737-8 and 737-9 airplanes with forward position light assemblies 84088-1 and 84088-2 Serial Numbers 1-199.

Description

Boeing has received reports from several operators experiencing either intermittent or inoperative LED modules on the 737 MAX forward position light (FPL) assemblies, P/N 84088-1 (LH) and 84088-2 (RH).

Background

The 737 MAX incorporates new FPL assemblies supplied by Astronics Luminescent Systems. Each respective side of the FPL system includes a FPL assembly consisting of an LRU Lens/Housing and an LRU Illumination Assembly which has two LED modules for redundancy. One LH or RH FPL Assembly is mounted into the leading edge of the respective winglet near where it mates with the leading edge of the wing.

After initial deliveries of the 737 MAX, Boeing has received reports from operators experiencing either intermittent or in-operative LED modules. In most cases, the LED modules recovers functionality after power cycles to the FPLs are performed. In a few cases, the LED modules remained in-operative and required replacement.

Status

Astronics has analyzed the in-service reports and determined that a possible cause of the failures is moisture contamination susceptibility. Moisture and condensation from normal aircraft operations can possibly develop on the power supply board, causing a failure. Astronics performed testing on factory units and were able to replicate the in-service failures by introducing moisture to the power supply assemblies. Once moisture is removed, the lights recover functionality.

An analysis of a returned intermittent light assembly found evidence of moisture contamination on the printed circuit card. The analysis confirmed that moisture contamination is the root cause of the intermittent issues on the forward position lights. Boeing and Astronics are proceeding with a design improvement to improve the light assembly moisture tolerance by changing the current silicon conformal coating to parylene conformal coating. Astronics repeated the same moisture tests with parylene conformal coated boards without any issues. The design improvement was incorporated starting at serial number 200. Astronics

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also released Service Bulletin 84088-33-001 to retrofit existing units.

For the LED hard failures, investigation revealed the LED failures were due to electrical overstress, shorting between the LEDs and the metal housing via the isotrate that interface between the LED board and the metal mounting base. Investigation revealed that during testing, some boards failed and Astronics replaced the isotrate to prevent the leakage but the LEDs may have already been impacted by the initial leakage. Astronics have already changed their production process going forward to scrap all failures instead of reworking these parts, which would address potential LED damaged caused during testing. For future design improvement, Astronics is looking for a more robust isotrate material to use to prevent test failures due to quality issues with the current isotrate material.

Interim Action

If a position light is found to be in-operative, perform a power cycle two times. Wait 5 seconds between power cycles. LED modules can recover functionality after power cycling, avoiding the need for dispatching on MMEL or immediate replacement of the LED module.

Final Action

The design improvement was incorporated starting at serial number 200 of the forward position light assemblies.

Production implementation of the improved light assemblies started in March 2018, and Astronics Service Bulletin 84088-33-001, which provides procedures to upgrade existing units, was released on 14-Mar-2018.

Boeing released service letter 737-SL-33-087 to inform operators of the FPL design improvement and upgrade information for in-service units.

Supplier Information

Astronics

Luminescent Systems, Inc.

130 Commerce Way

East Aurora, NY 14052

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FAX: 716-655-0309

CAGE: 14550

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	33-40-02		
Service Bulletin (SB)	84088-33-001		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-33-087		

Parts List

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Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
LH FORWARD POSITION LIGHT		Astronics	84088-1
RH FORWARD POSITION LIGHT		Astronics	84088-2

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

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